

number of people in a short amount of time. The underlying approaches used by Cambridge Analytica were developed at The Psychometrics Centre in the University of Cambridge, one of the leading institutions in the world dedicated to studying psychometrics.

The tool used to generate the psychographic profiles is actually available to the general public, and can use one of four kinds of footprints to generate the profiles. These are your likes on Facebook, your posts on Facebook, and your posts on Twitter. The final approach, is just to use a block of text, written by the target. There is no minimum amount of text necessary, but a good profile requires around 200 words or more. Cambridge Analytica has indicated that it has used data from Instagram and Snapchat as well, but has not specified if the data on these platforms were used to generate the psychographic profiles. We will be showing you how to scrub your data from all these platforms.

The first thing the tool does is to guess the psychological age and gender of the person. Even if these do not align with your actual age and gender, they are sufficient for the purposes of the advertisers to deliver their ads, because you are likely to react most strongly to the said targeting. The most important component of the psychographic profiles of an individual is a score on the big five personality traits, namely openness, conscientiousness, extraversion, agreeableness and neuroticism. Together, these traits are known as the OCEAN model. Apart from this profile, the same tool also generates your Jungian personality type. This is one of 16 personality types. The Jungian personality type provides information on how extraverted you are, how you obtain information, how you make decisions, and your general approach to life. No matter which approach is used the end result is a personality graph.

So as you can see, your psychographic profile is not really that much more informative than your demographic profile. The additional information provided may not be as accurate really. We took some tests to figure out our personality types, and

DELETE FACEBOOK

Backup your data

1. Login to Facebook desktop and enter 'Settings'
2. Go to 'General' account settings and click on 'Download a Copy of Your Facebook Data'
3. Click on 'Start my Archive', enter your password and click on 'Start my Archive' that appears on a pop-up window
4. All your Facebook data will be emailed to you

Deactivate your Facebook account

1. Go to General Account Settings
2. Select 'Manage Account' and click on 'Edit'
3. Click on Deactivate My Account. You will need to provide a reason
4. Logging in again, will reactivate your account

Delete your Facebook account

1. Go to digit.in/2KcvLCs
2. Click on "Delete my Account"

they were actually different from the results obtained through social media footprints. You can try out the difference yourself by checking out the tool

from Cambridge University researchers at digit.in/ams, and a quiz based test over at digit.in/16pers. Now if you still plan to delete your social media profiles, feel free to go ahead and follow the handy instructions that we've provided. However, you can totally fight back and troll social media platforms by feeding them misinformation.

FOOL THE PROFILING TOOLS

Now, while writing this story, we set out to see what we could do to change our psychographic profiles.

Facebook does not let you remove all your likes at one time. Under Facebook > Activity Log > Likes and reactions > Pages and Interests, you can unlike all your likes individually. This will remove all page likes from your Facebook profile, and not allow any tools to generate a psychographic profile based on your page likes. Another approach that you can use, is to go out and like a bunch of random pages. Doing this does mess up the psychographic profile. Fortunately, it does not wreak havoc on your timeline, and you will not see any big change in the type of content on your news feed. The

ISTJ Responsible, sincere, analytical, reserved, realistic, systematic. Hardworking and trustworthy with sound practical judgment.	ISFJ Warm, considerate, gentle, responsible, pragmatic, thorough. Devoted caretakers who enjoy being helpful to others.	INFJ Idealistic, organized, insightful, dependable, compassionate, gentle. Seek harmony and intellectual stimulation.	INTJ Innovative, independent, strategic, logical, reserved, insightful. Driven by their own original ideas to achieve improvements.
ISTP Action-oriented, logical, analytical, spontaneous, reserved, independent. Enjoy adventure, skilled at understanding how mechanical things work.	ISFP Gentle, sensitive, nurturing, helpful, flexible, realistic. Seek to create a personal environment that is both beautiful and practical.	INFP Sensitive, creative, idealistic, perceptive, caring, loyal. Value inner harmony and personal growth, focus on dreams and possibilities.	INTP Intellectual, logical, precise, reserved, flexible, imaginative. Original thinkers who enjoy speculation and creative problem solving.
ESTP Outgoing, realistic, action-oriented, curious, versatile, spontaneous. Pragmatic problem solvers and skillful negotiators.	ESFP Playful, enthusiastic, friendly, spontaneous, tactful, flexible. Have strong common sense, enjoy helping people in tangible ways.	ENFP Enthusiastic, creative, spontaneous, optimistic, supportive, playful. Value inspiration, enjoy starting new projects, see potential in others.	ENTP Inventive, enthusiastic, strategic, enterprising, inquisitive, versatile. Enjoy new ideas and challenges, value inspiration.
ESTJ Efficient, outgoing, analytical, systematic, dependable, realistic. Like to run the show and get things done in an orderly fashion.	ESFJ Friendly, outgoing, reliable, conscientious, organized, practical. Seek to be helpful and please others, enjoy being active and productive.	ENFJ Caring, enthusiastic, idealistic, organized, diplomatic, responsible. Skilled communicators who value connection with people.	ENTJ Strategic, logical, efficient, outgoing, ambitious, independent. Effective organizers of people and long-range planners.

The 16 types of personalities in the Jungian matrix